

Project Closure Report: Lessons Learned Analysis

Project: KU Campus Bite Version: 1.0 (Final Closure)

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Executive Summary:

This report documents the critical insights gained from the KU Campus Bite project. The project successfully demonstrated strong capabilities in **Contingency Planning** (managing resource absence) and **Quality Assurance** (continuous testing). The key area for improvement identified is the need for stricter, upfront vetting of **external API costs and requirements**. This analysis forms the foundation for future project planning.

Comprehensive Lessons Learned Register:

This register details all major observations, categorized by their phase in the Project Life Cycle, distinguishing between successes and failures.

Phase	Classification	Observation	Impact / Root Cause	Recommendation for Future Projects
Planning	Mistake	Initial project objectives were written vaguely, requiring formal revision.	Root Cause: Failure to immediately apply the standard Project Management framework. Caused initial document rework and process delay.	Mandate SMART Objectives from the very first draft of the Project Charter to ensure measurability.

Planning	Good Practice	Decision to prioritize manual, in-person interviews with canteen owners was highly successful.	Impact: Directly secured high stakeholder adoption (15/22 canteens) and gathered critical requirements that surveys often miss.	Always Prioritize Direct Stakeholder Interaction for core stakeholders to build trust and validate complex needs.
Planning	Good Practice	Successfully built float (slack) into the schedule for development activities.	Success: The buffer absorbed minor technical issues, preventing impacts on the Critical Path and final delivery date.	Incorporate Schedule Float: Allocate 10–15% of task time as an explicit buffer in all future schedules.
Execution	Mistake	Failed to fully research the actual recurring cost and prerequisites for the external WhatsApp API.	Impact: Created a significant budget risk. Success: The risk was mitigated by decisive action to downgrade scope to the free Twilio Sandbox POC .	Mandate a "Cost & Requirements Vetting" Checklist for all external APIs before they are included in the baseline scope.
Execution	Good Practice	Team successfully managed the risk of Key Resource Absence when a frontend member became severely ill.	Success: The immediate execution of the Contingency Plan (task reallocation) prevented a major schedule delay.	For all High-Priority risks, ensure the Contingency Plan is formally documented, shared, and ready for immediate execution.

Execution	Mistake	Allotting the main interface development as a single, large task led to a failure of real-time communication .	Impact: Late discovery of blockers and a deadline overrun. Root Cause: Lack of mandatory daily reporting.	Mandate Daily, Granular Control. Enforce mandatory daily status reporting on sub-tasks (small work packages).
Execution	Good Practice	Adopted a successful practice of continuous, incremental testing after every code change.	Success: This preventative QA approach ensured zero critical defects at launch.	Enforce Continuous Component Testing and regression testing as a mandatory part of the development process.
Closure	Good Practice	Consistent, open communication and mutual support were maintained throughout the project.	Success: This environment fostered trust, made task reallocation easier, and enabled the smooth execution of all contingency plans.	Prioritize Team Cohesion and PM Support to create a safe space for issue reporting in all future projects.

Conclusion and Future Actions:

The project confirmed that effective Project Management relies on a balance between rigorous planning (SMART, Float) and flexible, decisive control (Risk Mitigation, Scope Change). The team's successful response to resource absence and budget risk is a core competency to be retained.

Key Action Items for Future Projects (Phase 2):

1. **Re-scope the Canteen Notification:** Budget for the paid API tier required to fully deliver the canteen order notification feature.

2. **Mature Agile Practices:** Implement lessons from communication and control failures (e.g., daily check-ins, granular tasks) to strictly mature the existing Agile process for Phase 2, focusing on continuous flow and transparency.